Sayyal | سيّال

A Secondary-Market for Saudi Debt Crowdfunding Platforms

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1. The Idea in Brief

In Saudi debt crowdfunding, individuals invest in small businesses through licensed online platforms and earn a fixed profit. The problem is that the money is locked for 12–36 months, and there is no way to sell the investment early if the investor needs cash.

Sayyal (سيّال, "liquid") solves this by adding a resale market to existing crowdfunding platforms. An investor who wants to exit lists their investment for sale, another investor buys it, and Sayyal makes sure the price is fair, the trade is safe, and ownership is transferred correctly.

In one sentence

A system that lets crowdfunding investors sell early to other investors inside the platform they already use.

2. The Problem

- **Investors are stuck:** no option to get their money back before end of the term.
- **Platforms have no tool for it:** there is no ready system to price, match, and transfer the investments between users.
- **Risk of abuse:** without our controls, people could sell at unfair prices or trade with their own second accounts.

3. How It Works

Step	What happens
1. List	The investor would choose an investment to sell. Sayyal suggests a fair price based on remaining payments and the payment history.
2. Buy	Other investors browse available investments, filter them by remaining time, price, payment record and buy.
3. Check	Sayyal automatically checks the price and looks for suspicious signs, such as the buyer and seller using the same device or bank account.
4. Transfer	The money moves, the ownership is transferred, a transfer document is created, and the platform is updated.

Example

Noura invested in a strict 12-month opportunity. After 6 months, she needs cash, so she lists her investment. Sayyal would suggest a fair price of about SAR 5760 for example. Khalid buys it, the system finds nothing suspicious, and the transfer completes. Noura would get her money, and Khalid receives responsibility of the remaining payments.

4. What We Will Build

Part	Who uses it	What it does
Sayyal Engine (backend)	Crowdfunding platforms	The core logic: fair pricing, matching buyers and sellers, fraud checks, transfers, and records of every action
Investor Web App	Investors	A crowdfunding platform where users can view their investments, sell, browse and buy
Admin Dashboard	Compliance and platform staff	Review any suspicious trades, adjust the pricing settings, and view general market activity

Since we cannot use a real platform or real money, we will simulate the platform, payments and identity verification using realistic test data.

5. Main Features

- Fair price suggestions based on remaining payments and how reliably the business has paid.
- Marketplace with search and filters for investments.
- The same investment can never be sold to two buyers.
- Fraud detection for trades between related accounts.
- Automatic transfer document for every completed trade as per compliance.
- Full activity log for general compliance and review, with an Arabic and English interface.

6. Technologies

Area	Technology	Why
Frontend (web apps)	Next.js (React), TypeScript, Tailwind CSS	For modern, fast web interfaces
Backend	Python, Node.js, TypeScript	Organized, scalable coding for building APIs
Database	SQL	Reliable for data and safe transactions
Caching & background jobs	Redis	Helps with double selling and runs background tasks
APIs	REST API	Lets any crowdfunding platform connect to Sayyal
Security	JWT authentication, role-based access, encryption	Protects users and financial data
Documents	PDFs	Creates the transfer document for each trade
Testing & deployment	GitHub	Testing and easy deployment
Design & management	Figma, GitHub, Jira	UI design, version control, and task tracking

This is a general overview, subject to change.

Why this project fits Information Systems

It combines business analysis of a real market gap, system design of a multi-user platform, data management for financial records, and security and compliance requirements, all delivered as a working system.